



Bundle

Automatic, reversible grouping for scattered conversations.
A feature specification for Claude.

DOCUMENT	ZW-FS-001 · Bundle · v1.0
STATUS	Published
AUTHORS	The Zugzwang Foundation
LAST UPDATED	2026-08-06
SUBJECT	Claude — claude.ai and the Claude desktop app
READER	Product-minded humans. This is a user-side specification; it contains no schema, no APIs, and no implementation detail.

An independent proposal. The Zugzwang Foundation is not affiliated with, commissioned by, or endorsed by Anthropic. “Claude” is used nominatively to name the product this proposal addresses; all interface depictions are illustrative reconstructions, not screenshots.

What this document is

A formal specification for a feature that does not exist, written to the standard of one that ships. It describes a single, deliberately small addition to Claude's chat index: a toggle that gathers scattered conversations about the same ongoing concern into named, collapsible sections — and changes nothing else.

The document is user-side by design. Flows are described as journeys a person takes, not procedures a server runs. States are described as screens, not enums. Acceptance criteria are observable outcomes anyone can check by looking. Where the format borrows the discipline of an engineering specification — hard invariants, exhaustive states, a negative-space section — the payload is always what a person sees and does.

Standing facts

- **Non-affiliation.** This document is published by the Zugzwang Foundation, an independent non-profit. It is not affiliated with, commissioned by, reviewed by, or endorsed by Anthropic. It is a suggestion, made in public, in the format the authors believe a good suggestion deserves.
- **Product accuracy.** Every statement about Claude's current behaviour was verified against the live product on 2026-08-06. Claude ships features gradually, so individual accounts may differ; where behaviour varies by account, the document says so rather than asserting one variant.
- **Depictions.** Interface figures follow Claude's shipped design system — its dark theme, type, and component grammar — so that the proposal can be judged in its real habitat. They are reconstructions drawn for this document.
- **Precedence.** If this document and common sense disagree, common sense wins. The invariants in §5 are the only part the authors consider non-negotiable.

How to read it in five minutes

Read §1, look at Figure 3, then read §5. Everything else is the working-out.

In this document

§0	Document metadata	4
§1	One-paragraph product description	4
§2	The problem — Meera’s four months	5
§3	Glossary	6
§4	Goals and non-goals	7
§5	The four invariants	8
§6	The surface today	9
§7	What Bundle adds	10
§8	Journeys	12
§9	States and copy	15
§10	Sensitive names and hiding	16
§11	Stability over time	17
§12	Acceptance criteria	18
§13	Out of scope	19
§14	Open questions · Change log	20

Document metadata

§0

Version	1.0 — first published version. Semantic versioning; a change to any §5 invariant bumps the major.
Feature name	Bundle — the feature. The sections it creates are bundles . The verb is bundle . The control is the toggle “Bundle chats”.
Platforms	Claude on the web and the Claude desktop app. Mobile is explicitly out of scope for v1 (§13).
Dependencies	Requires memory to be on. Bundle reads nothing that memory does not already read (§5, INV-4).
Default	Off. Turning it on is a deliberate act; turning it off restores the previous view exactly (§5, INV-1; §8, J-7).
Verification date	All statements about current Claude behaviour verified on the live product, 2026-08-06.

THE FEATURE IN ONE BREATH

One-paragraph product description

§1

Bundle is a toggle on Claude’s chat index. Off, nothing changes. On, Claude reads the shape of your past conversations — the same distilled understanding memory already holds — and gathers scattered chats about the same ongoing concern into named, collapsible sections on the sidebar and the Chats and tasks page: nine pension questions asked across four months become one place called Retirement planning. A bundle is a view, not a move — every chat stays exactly where it was, the chronological list remains beneath, and the person a name describes can rename it, remove a chat from it, hide it, or switch the whole thing off and get the previous screen back, unchanged. Chats inside Projects are untouched: Projects are the grouping you chose in advance; Bundle is for everything you didn’t.

The problem — Meera's four months

§2

Meera is seventy-one. In March she asks Claude what a defined-contribution pension is. Three weeks later, whether a letter from her bank is genuine. In April, how annuities work, and how withdrawals are taxed. In May, what the senior citizen savings scheme pays, and how to budget on a fixed income. In June she asks the tax question again — not because she forgot the answer, but because she cannot find the chat that contains it. By the end of June she has also collected a list of questions for a financial adviser she has not yet met.

She has had **one conversation**, in her head, for four months. The chat index has recorded **nine unrelated items**, interleaved with recipes, birthday messages, and everything else a life produces — each drifting further down a reverse-chronological list as newer chats arrive.

The tools that exist each miss her from a different side. **Search** works when you know what to look for; it cannot stop the June re-ask, because the failure is not recall of words, it is the absence of a place. **Projects** are excellent when you know in advance that something is a body of work — and nobody creates a project on the day of a single pension question, because on that day it isn't one yet. **Memory** means Claude understands her situation better with each chat; the index she scrolls has no way to show it.

The gap is precise: **retroactive, zero-effort structure, for the person who will never build structure themselves.** Meera will not open Settings. She will not name anything. If the tool forgot, she assumes that is what tools do.

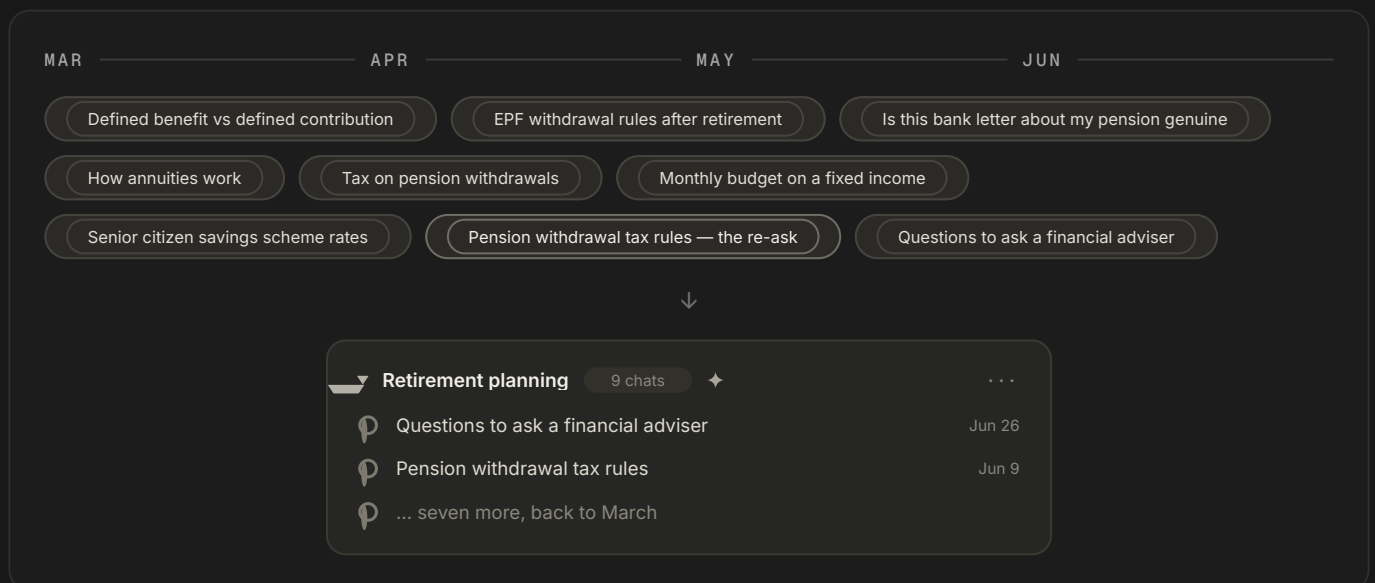


Figure 1 — Four months, nine chats, one concern. The list records transactions; the person is having a continuity. Bundle gives the continuity a place and a name.

§3 Glossary

TERM	DEFINITION	WHERE YOU SEE IT
Bundle	The feature: the toggle and the behaviour it enables.	The toggle “Bundle chats” on the chat index.
bundle (a)	A named, collapsible group of related chats, formed by Claude, owned by you.	A section on the sidebar and the Chats and tasks page.
Chat index	The two surfaces that list conversations: the sidebar’s recent chats and the Chats and tasks page. One preference governs both.	Sidebar; <code>claude.ai/chats</code> .
Ongoing concern	A subject a person returns to across many chats and weeks — a retirement, a move, a language, a renovation.	What a bundle is of.
Ungrouped chat	A chat no bundle claims. It simply remains in the chronological list — unlabelled, unmoved.	The list beneath the bundles.
Neutral name	A deliberately plain label for a bundle on a sensitive subject; names the domain, never the person’s condition.	§10.
Hidden bundle	A bundle removed from view at the owner’s request. Its chats remain in the list; nothing else changes.	§8 J-6; §10.
Memory	Claude’s existing, user-controllable understanding of your chats. Bundle’s prerequisite and its only source (§5, INV-4).	Settings › Capabilities.
Project	Claude’s existing user-created container for a body of work. Out of Bundle’s reach entirely.	Sidebar project sections.

Goals and non-goals

§4

4.1 Goals — numbered, observable

- | | |
|----|---|
| G1 | A returning concern is one glance away: its chats sit together under one named section on the index, newest first inside. |
| G2 | Zero effort before value. No setup, no naming, no filing is required for bundles to form. The person's first contribution is optional correction, never construction. |
| G3 | Nothing is displaced. The chronological list remains complete, ordered, and reachable beneath the bundles, always. |
| G4 | Every automatic decision is correctable within two clicks of where it is visible: rename the bundle, remove a chat, hide the bundle. |
| G5 | Off means off. Disabling the toggle restores the prior view exactly, with no residue and no dialog. |

4.2 Non-goals

- | | |
|-----|---|
| NG1 | Not a replacement for Projects, and not a competitor to them. A bundle has no knowledge base, no instructions, no memory space of its own. It is a shelf, not a room. |
| NG2 | Not a new place chats live. A bundle is a view over the list. There is no "inside" to move things into and nothing to lose by leaving. |
| NG3 | Not on mobile in v1. The drawer deserves its own design, not a squeezed desktop (§13). |
| NG4 | Not a change to anything else. Search, memory, Projects, pins, and every existing behaviour are byte-for-byte what they were — and with the toggle off, so is the entire product. |

The four invariants

§5

Everything else in this document is a proposal. These four are its spine: each names the failure it prevents, because features like this one die in known ways.

INV-1 The chronological list is never replaced

STATEMENT Bundles render above the chronological list, never instead of it. Every chat remains reachable in time order at all times, bundled or not.

RATIONALE Automatic organisation that replaces a known view gets ripped out by its users; organisation that supplements a known view gets kept. People navigate by spatial memory; the list is the ground they stand on.

FAILURE IT PREVENTS The person turns Bundle on, cannot find yesterday's chat where it always was, turns Bundle off, and never touches it again.

INV-2 A bundle is a view, never a move

STATEMENT Forming, renaming, hiding, or dissolving a bundle changes nothing about any chat: not its place in the list, not its project, not its content, not its order. There is no action on a bundle that can lose a chat.

RATIONALE The toggle must be free to try. The moment grouping can move or hide a person's things, every automatic decision becomes a threat and the feature acquires a fear it never sheds.

FAILURE IT PREVENTS "Where did my chat go?" — the one question this feature must make unaskable.

INV-3 Every generated name is correctable by the person it describes

STATEMENT Rename, remove-a-chat, and hide are never more than two clicks from the bundle's name. A name the person sets is theirs: Claude never overwrites it. And no generated name reaches the screen without passing a safety filter (§10).

RATIONALE A bundle's name is a label on someone's own life, printed on their primary navigation surface. Cheap correction is what lets automatic classification be forgiven its mistakes; its absence is why such features are hated.

FAILURE IT PREVENTS A wrong, generic, or harmful label standing over a person's history with no obvious way to answer back.

INV-4 Bundle sees only what memory already sees

STATEMENT Bundle requires memory to be on and reads nothing memory does not already read. Incognito chats never bundle. Project chats never bundle. Turning memory off pauses Bundle with it.

RATIONALE The consent already given for memory is the consent Bundle operates under. A grouping feature that widened what is read would be a new privacy surface wearing a convenience's clothes.

FAILURE IT PREVENTS A feature that quietly enlarges the data question instead of inheriting its answer.

The surface today

§6

Bundle attaches to two surfaces that already exist. Both were verified on the live product on the date above.

The sidebar. Beneath the navigation — New, Chats and tasks, Projects, Artifacts, Scheduled, Customize — the sidebar lists recent conversations. For chats organised into Projects, it already renders named, collapsible sections: a project's name as a header, its chats beneath. **The pattern Bundle needs already ships.**

The Chats and tasks page. A flat, reverse-chronological list — title and relative time — with view controls in the header: search, Filter by All, Select, New. No date headers, no grouping of any kind.

The per-chat menu. Each conversation carries a menu: Pin **P**, Mark as unread **U**, Rename **R**, Change project, Remove from project, Delete **D**. Chats can already be moved into and out of containers from the row itself — Bundle's corrections mirror this exact grammar.

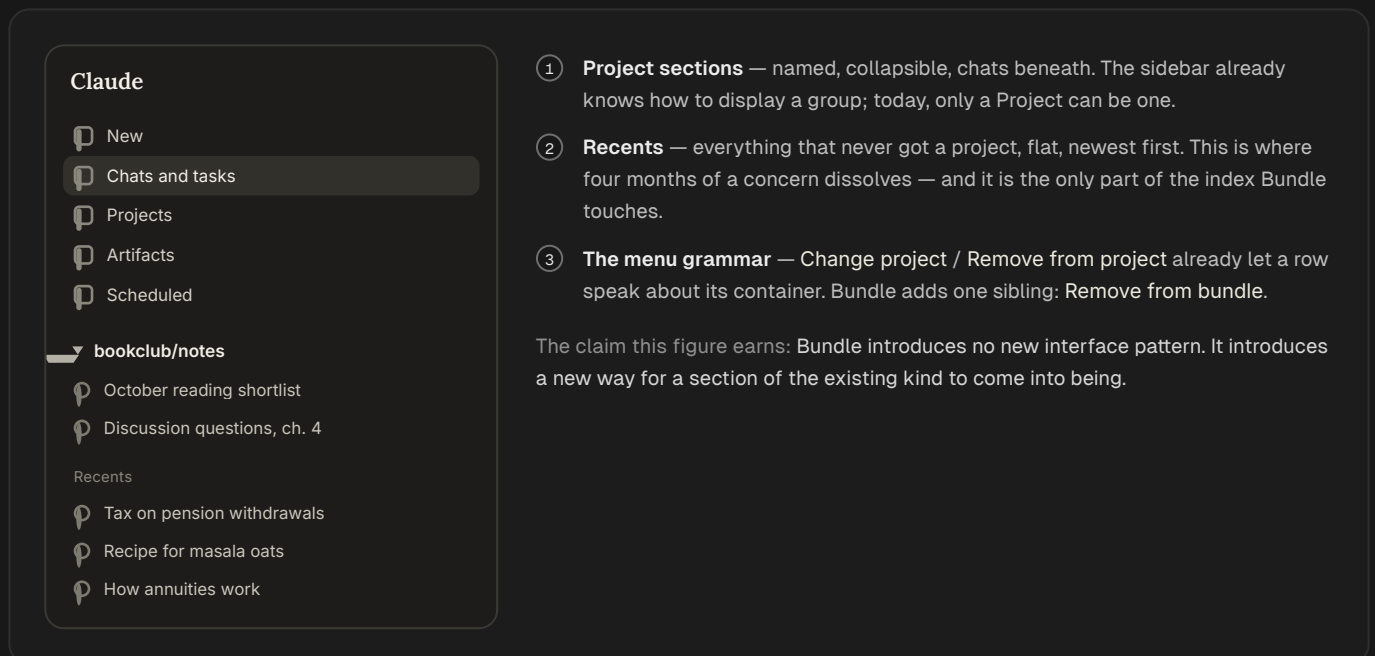


Figure 2 — The index as it ships today: grouped where a person planned ahead, flat everywhere else.

What Bundle adds

§7

One toggle. Bundle chats sits in the view controls of the Chats and tasks page, with a mirrored control on the sidebar's Recents header. It is one preference surfaced in two places; flipping either flips both. Off by default.

When on, bundles render as sections above the chronological list — the same visual grammar as project sections, with two honest differences: a small mark ♦ notes that Claude formed the group, and the section's menu speaks bundle verbs: Rename bundle, Hide bundle. The list continues beneath, complete, under All chats.

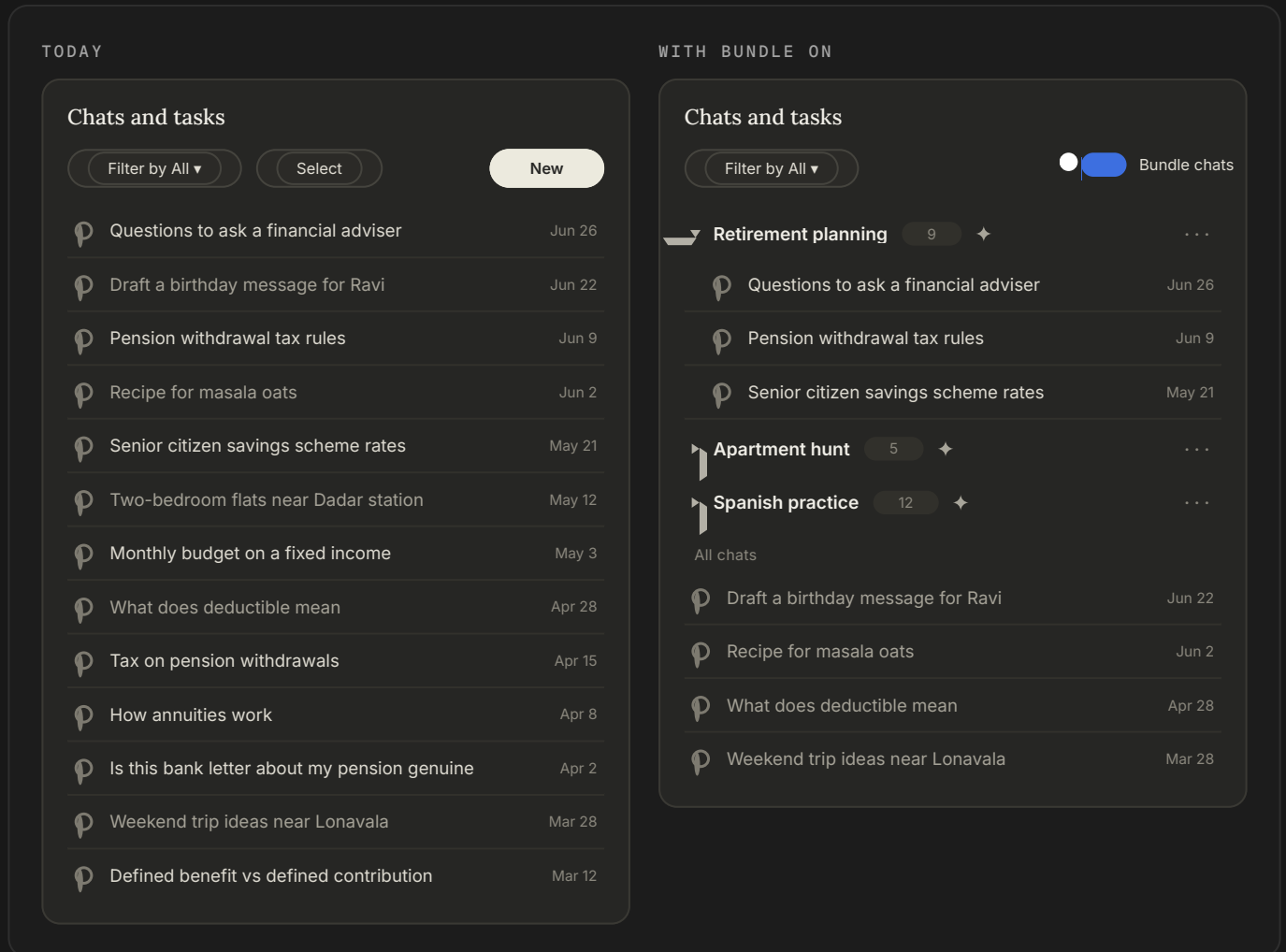


Figure 3 – The same nine-plus chats, both ways. Left: the concern is dissolved in time order. Right: three concerns have places; everything else stays exactly where it was, under All chats.

7.1 Anatomy of a bundle

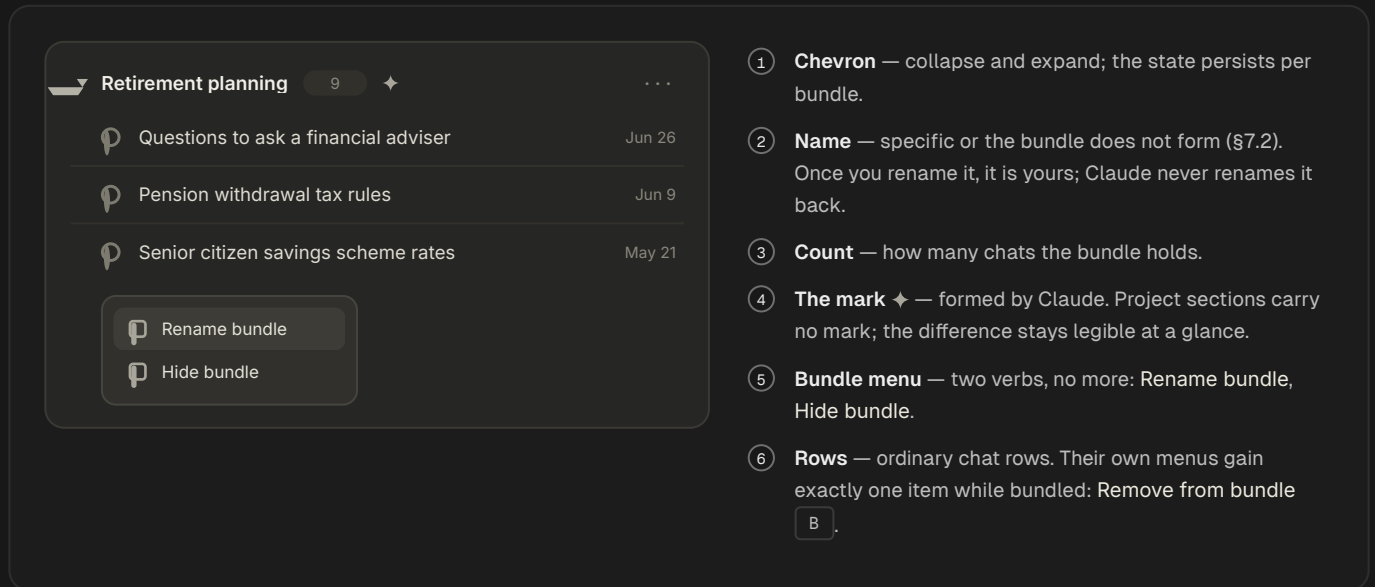


Figure 4 — Everything a bundle is, on one card. Six parts, two verbs, one new menu item.

7.2 The formation standard — when a bundle may exist

A bundle forms only when three things are true at once:

- **Several chats** — a handful about the same thing, not two coincidences (threshold tuned in practice; §14, Q1).
- **One ongoing concern** — the chats share a subject a person returns to, not merely a vocabulary.
- **A name Claude can state plainly and specifically** — Retirement planning, Apartment hunt. If the honest name would be Miscellaneous, the bundle does not form.

There is deliberately **no residue bucket** — no “Other, 247” announcing everything Claude could not understand. Chats that earn no bundle simply remain in the chronological list, unlabelled and unashamed. The list is the residue, and it was always fine.

Chats inside **Projects** are never candidates: they are already grouped, by the person, which outranks any inference. **Incognito** chats are never candidates: they sit outside memory, and Bundle sees only what memory sees (INV-4). A chat belongs to **at most one bundle** — ambiguity resolves to the stronger concern, and the person's Remove from bundle is final.

§8 Journeys

J-1 Turning Bundle on

BEFORE	Memory is on. The index looks exactly as it does today.
STEPS	1. On Chats and tasks, Meera's grandson points at the view controls: Bundle chats, off. 2. She flips it. The list stays put; above it, Finding related chats... and two quiet skeleton sections appear. 3. Seconds later, three bundles are there — Retirement planning · 9, Apartment hunt · 5, Spanish practice · 12 — each with the spark mark. Beneath them, All chats, untouched.
NEVER	No chat moved. No dialog interrupted. Nothing asked her to name, file, or decide anything. If she flips the toggle back, the screen is exactly what it was.

J-2 A new chat joins its bundle

BEFORE	Retirement planning exists with 9 chats.
STEPS	1. In July, Meera asks Claude to compare two annuity quotes. The chat behaves as every chat does — it appears at the top of her recents. 2. On her next visit to the index, the chat sits inside Retirement planning · 10.
NEVER	The bundle's name never changes silently to accommodate a new chat, and existing chats are never reshuffled between bundles in the background (§11). Growth is incremental; identity is stable.

J-3 Renaming a bundle

BEFORE	Claude named a bundle Apartment hunt . Meera thinks of it as the flat for her granddaughter.
STEPS	1. Bundle menu › Rename bundle. The name becomes an inline text field, selected. 2. She types Anaya's flat and presses Enter.
NEVER	Claude never overwrites a person's name — not on new chats, not on regeneration, not ever (INV-3). A renamed bundle is settled.

J-4 Removing a chat from a bundle

BEFORE	A budgeting chat landed in Retirement planning ; Meera thinks of it as its own thing.
STEPS	1. Chat row menu › Remove from bundle B . 2. The row leaves the section. The chat remains in All chats, exactly where its date puts it. Toast: Removed from bundle. Undo
NEVER	The chat is not re-added later — a removal is remembered. And removal never deletes, archives, or relocates anything (INV-2).

J-5 Hiding a bundle

BEFORE	A bundle exists that Meera does not want printed on her sidebar (\$10 for why this matters).
STEPS	1. Bundle menu › Hide bundle. 2. One small confirmation: “Hide this bundle? Your chats stay in your list. The bundle just stops appearing.” 3. She confirms. The section is gone; every chat is visible chronologically. Toast: Bundle hidden. Undo
NEVER	Hiding touches no chat. A hidden bundle stays hidden — it does not reform under another name.

J-6 Turning Bundle off

STEPS	1. She flips Bundle chats off. Instantly, the index is the flat list it was before — no dialog, no residue, no changed order (G5).
NEVER	Her corrections are not thrown away: names, removals, and hides are kept, so turning Bundle back on resumes rather than restarts.

J-7 The dependency — memory off

BEFORE	A person with memory turned off finds the toggle.
STEPS	1. The toggle is disabled, with one sentence beneath it: “Bundle uses memory to understand your chats. Turn on memory to bundle them.” — linking to Settings. 2. Turning memory off while Bundle is on pauses Bundle the same moment; the index returns to the flat list until memory returns.
NEVER	Bundle never runs where memory does not (INV-4), and never nags: one sentence, one link, no more.

8.1 The first run, drawn

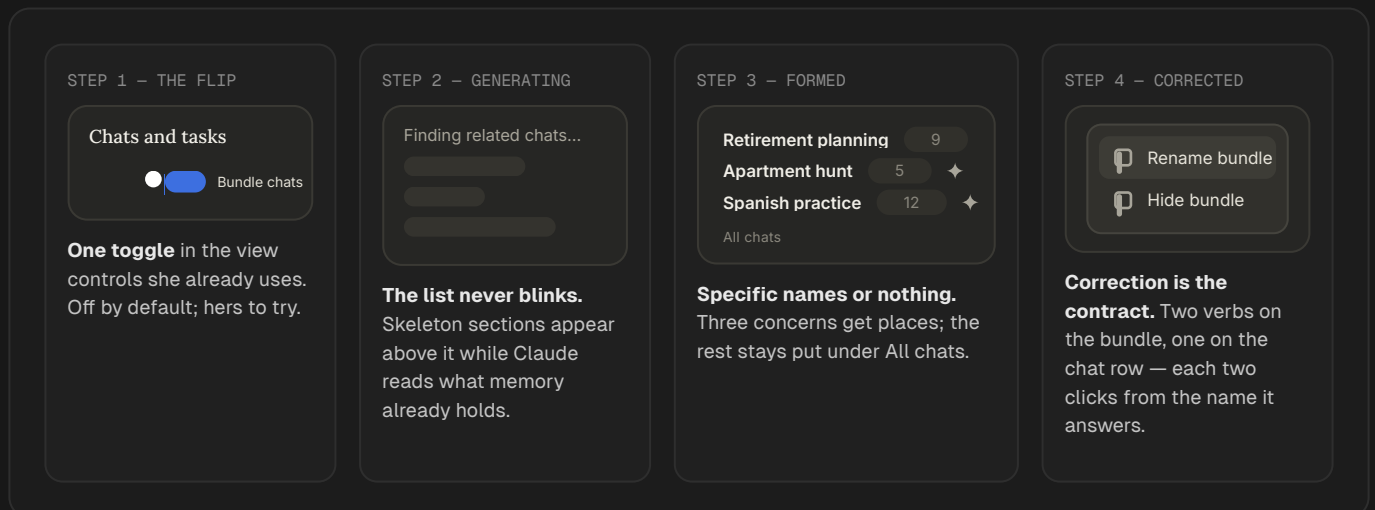


Figure 5 – First run, four beats: flip, generate, form, correct. At no point does the person construct anything.

8.2 The row's menu, before and after

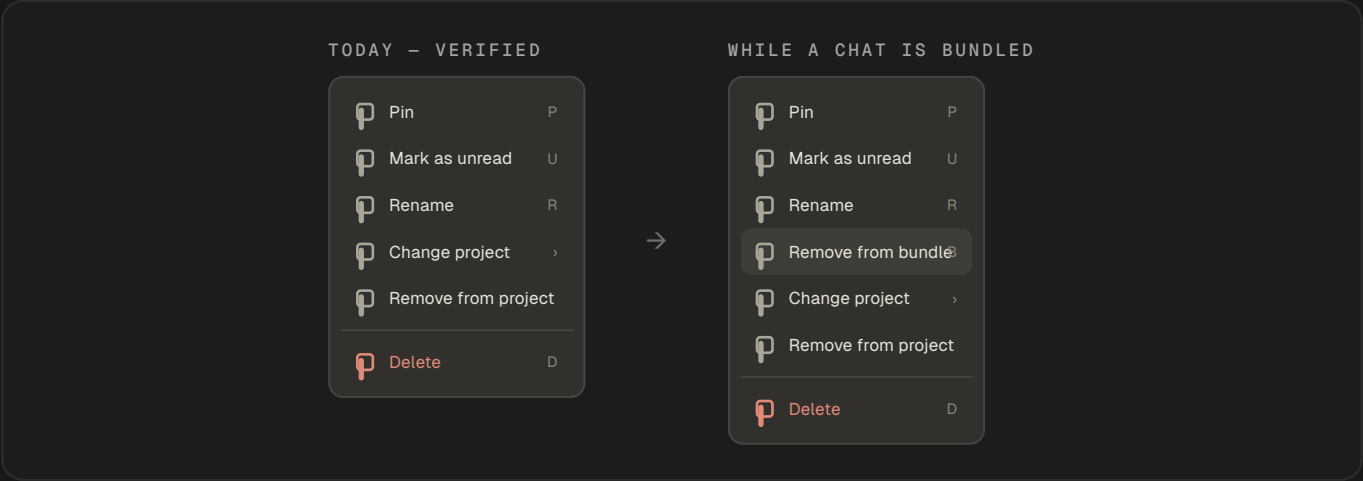


Figure 6 - One new line in a menu that already exists, on a free shortcut. That is the entire cost to the row.

8.3 The sidebar mirror

The sidebar shows the same bundles under Recents, governed by the same preference — a compact control on the Recents header mirrors the toggle, so the two surfaces can never disagree (A13). Project sections sit above, untouched and unmarked; bundles are the sections with the spark.

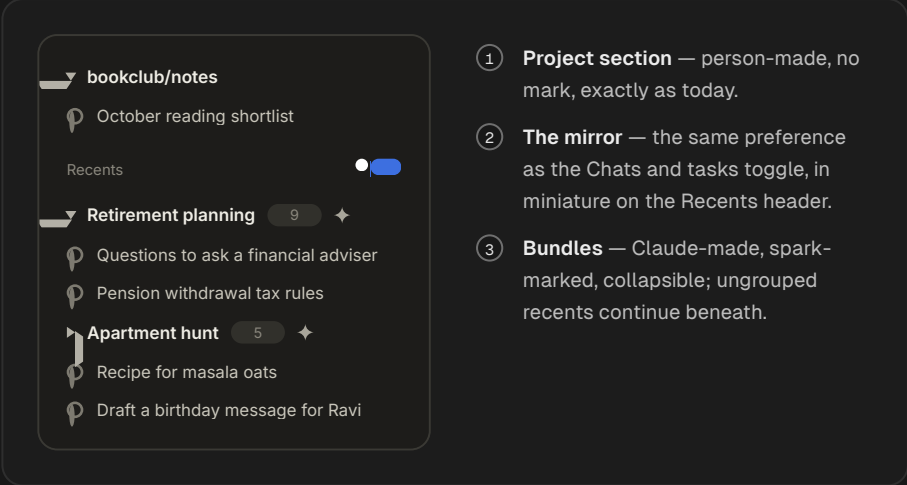


Figure 7 - One preference, two surfaces. The sidebar's existing section grammar, now with two ways for a section to exist.

§9 States and copy

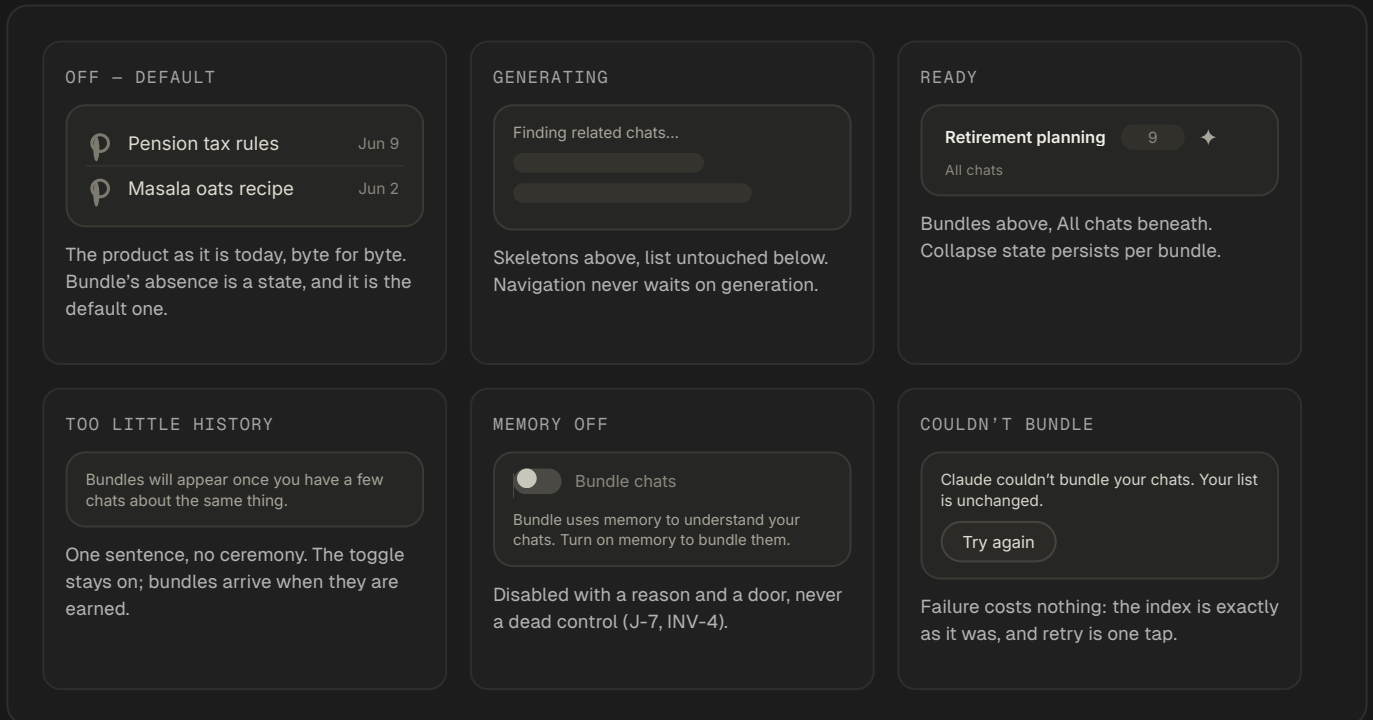


Figure 8 – The six states. In every one of them, the chronological list is present and correct – that is INV-1 drawn six times.

9.1 The copy register — every string, verbatim

WHERE	STRING	NOTES
Toggle	Bundle chats	Verb first, like every Claude control.
Toggle tooltip	Group related chats into bundles you can rename, edit, or hide.	One sentence; the three verbs are the trust story.
Generating	Finding related chats...	Present tense, specific, quiet.
First formation note	Bundled by Claude. Rename, remove chats, or hide any bundle.	Shown once, dismissible.
Thin history	Bundles will appear once you have a few chats about the same thing.	No number promised; no nagging.
Memory dependency	Bundle uses memory to understand your chats. Turn on memory to bundle them.	States the mechanism honestly; links Settings.
Bundle menu	Rename bundle · Hide bundle	Two verbs. Nothing else earns a place.
Row menu addition	Remove from bundle	Shortcut B. Mirrors “Remove from project”.
Hide confirmation	Hide this bundle? Your chats stay in your list. The bundle just stops appearing.	Buttons: Cancel / Hide bundle. The action keeps its name.
Toasts	Removed from bundle. Undo · Bundle hidden. Undo	Every destructive-looking act is undoable in place.
Failure	Claude couldn't bundle your chats. Your list is unchanged.	Says what happened and what didn't. Button: Try again.

Sensitive names and hiding

§10

A chat title lives one click deep. A bundle name is **printed on the navigation surface** — visible to anyone glancing at a shared screen, a projector, a family laptop. Automatic naming of a person's own history is therefore a safety surface, not a copywriting task, and it gets its own rules:

- R1 **Name the domain, never the struggle.** A cluster of chats about a health scare is, at most, **Health** — never a condition, a symptom, or a diagnosis. Money trouble is **Finances**. A legal matter is **Legal**. The neutral name is deliberately boring; boring is the feature.
- R2 **Every generated name passes a safety filter before first render.** No name reaches the screen containing diagnoses, other people's names, intimate detail, or language a person would not want read over their shoulder. A name that fails is replaced by its domain word; a cluster with no safe name does not form.
- R3 **Hide is one menu away, and it is total.** Hide bundle removes the section, keeps every chat, and is undoable. A hidden bundle does not return, reform, or resurface under a new name.
- R4 **What memory does not see, Bundle cannot say.** Incognito chats never bundle; nothing outside memory's reach can appear in a name (INV-4).
- R5 **In doubt, don't.** An unformed bundle costs a convenience. A wrong label on someone's life costs trust that does not come back. The bias is written into the formation standard (§7.2) and it is not a tunable.

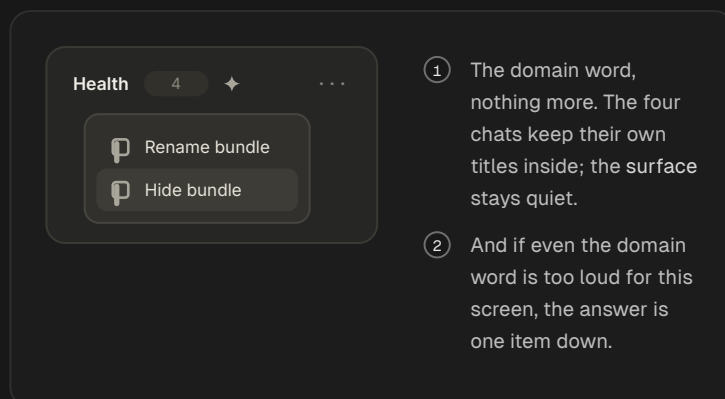


Figure 9 — The neutral name and its exit. R1 chooses the word; R3 guarantees the door.

§11 Stability over time

A group that keeps changing its name and contents is worse than no group: it breaks the spatial memory it promised to serve. Bundle's behaviour over time is therefore conservative by rule:

- **Names are stable.** A bundle's name changes on exactly two events: the person renames it, or the person explicitly asks Claude to regenerate. Never silently, never on a schedule, never because a new chat arrived.
- **Membership grows; it does not churn.** New chats join incrementally (J-2). Existing chats are never reshuffled between bundles in the background. Full recomputation happens only when the person turns Bundle off and on again — a visible, chosen event.
- **Corrections are permanent.** A removed chat stays removed. A hidden bundle stays hidden. A renamed bundle keeps its name. The person's decisions always outrank the model's next opinion.
- **Order is boring on purpose.** Bundles sort by most recent activity; chats inside a bundle keep newest-first. No novelty resorting, no "smart" reordering.

§12 Acceptance criteria

#	OBSERVABLE OUTCOME	ANCHORS
A1	With the toggle off, the chat index is indistinguishable from today's product, in content, order, and behaviour.	G5 · NG4
A2	With memory off, the toggle is disabled and explains itself in one sentence with a working link to Settings.	INV-4 · J-7
A3	After bundles form, every chat visible before is still reachable in the chronological list, in the same order.	INV-1 · G3
A4	No bundle is ever named Other, Miscellaneous, General, or an equivalent; a cluster that cannot be named specifically does not form.	§7.2
A5	No bundle ever contains a Project chat or an incognito chat.	INV-4
A6	Rename is reachable in two clicks from the bundle name; a person's name is never subsequently altered by Claude.	INV-3 · J-3
A7	Remove from bundle leaves the chat in the chronological list and the chat is not re-added on any later pass.	J-4 · §11
A8	Hiding a bundle removes the section, changes nothing else, offers Undo, and the bundle does not reform.	J-5 · R3
A9	Turning the toggle off restores the prior view instantly, with no dialog and no residue; turning it back on restores names, removals, and hides.	G5 · J-6
A10	A new chat on an existing concern joins its bundle without the bundle's name changing and without any other chat moving.	J-2 · §11
A11	A sensitive concern surfaces, at most, under a neutral domain name; no generated name contains a diagnosis, another person's name, or intimate detail.	R1 · R2
A12	If generation fails, the index is untouched and the failure state offers retry in one tap.	§9
A13	The sidebar and the Chats and tasks page always agree: one preference, one set of bundles, both surfaces.	§7
A14	Deleting a chat behaves exactly as today; no action on a bundle — hide, rename, remove, toggle-off — can delete, archive, or relocate a chat.	INV-2

§13 Out of scope for v1

NOT IN V1	WHY NOT NOW
Carrying context into a new chat	The continuity prize — starting a chat from a bundle that already knows the story. Deferred so v1 stays a pure view with zero write-behaviour; it is the obvious v2 and deserves its own specification.
Promoting a bundle to a Project	The natural graduation for a concern that becomes a body of work. Projects is a shipped feature this proposal deliberately leaves untouched.
Bundling Project chats	Already grouped — by the person, which outranks any inference. Bundle grooms only what Projects left behind.
Mobile	The drawer's constraints deserve their own design pass, not a squeezed desktop layout.
Merge and split	Correction beyond rename / remove / hide adds a management surface v1 does not need to prove the idea.
Multiple membership	One chat, one bundle. Two homes for one chat doubles every question — counts, removal, hiding — for a marginal gain.
A “Miscellaneous” bucket	The chronological list already is the honest residue. A labelled bucket of everything-Claude-couldn't-name would make the feature look broken on day one.
Search scoping, notifications, sharing	The problem is a missing place, not missing plumbing. None of these was asked for by the story in §2.

Open questions - Change log

§14

#	QUESTION	WORKING	DEFAULT
Q1	Minimum history before the toggle produces anything — how many related chats earn a bundle?	A small handful; tuned against real distributions, never promised as a number in copy.	
Q2	Do corrections survive a full off→on recomputation cycle?	Yes — names, removals, and hides persist across cycles (§11); recomputation refits membership around them.	
Q3	Sidebar behaviour when a person accrues many bundles?	Show the most recently active few; Show all bundles opens Chats and tasks.	
Q4	What language is a bundle named in?	The dominant language of its own chats — the name should read like the person wrote it.	

Change log

VERSION	DATE	CHANGE
1.0	2026-08-06	First published version.



Bundle — a feature specification for Claude
Published by the Zugzwang Foundation · zugzwangworld.com

An independent proposal. The Zugzwang Foundation is not affiliated with, commissioned by, or endorsed by Anthropic. Interface depictions are illustrative reconstructions. Product facts verified against the live product on 2026-08-06; Claude ships gradually, and individual accounts may differ.